

School Committee Policy Review Subcommittee
Monday, June 12, 2017
8:40 AM – 10:00 AM
5th Floor Conference, Town Hall

Policy Review Subcommittee members present: Mr. Chang (Chairman) and Ms. Schreiner-Oldham.

Policy Review Subcommittee members absent: Mr. Glover.

School Staff present: Ms. Dunn, Mr. Zimmerman, and Ms. Coyne.

Others present: Assistant Town Counsel Patty Correa, Scott Murphy, Lawrence parent Danna Perry, and a Lincoln parent.

1) Approval of the Minutes of the May 31, 2017 Policy Review Subcommittee Meeting

On a motion of Mr. Chang and seconded by Ms. Schreiner-Oldham, the Policy Review Subcommittee voted unanimously to approve the minutes of the May 31, 2017 Policy Review Subcommittee meeting.

2) Discussion of 2017-2018 School Year Priorities

Ms. Dunn and Mr. Zimmerman identified priorities for the 2017-2018 School Year, including Public Schools of Brookline (PSB) Policies on Food Services, Discipline, Attendance, Student Activities, and Field Trips. The proposed Food Services policies are almost ready for review. The PSB Discipline Policy needs to be aligned with our new policies on Bullying Prevention and Hazing, and with Title VI and Title IX language. Our Attendance Policy should be standardized across the district and align with regulatory changes. The PSB Student Activities Policy has not been updated for several years.

The PSB Student Field Trip Policy needs to be substantially revised, with new or revised language on items such as inclusiveness, chaperones, insurance, and the approval process. The Policy needs to align with our Bullying Prevention, Hazing, and Wellness Policies. Staff will compile a list of currently offered student trips.

The Subcommittee discussed policies related to security and emergency response. Ms. Dunn stated that a small team has been meeting regularly to look at these issues. A Memorandum of Agreement between the Schools and the Police Department is being developed. Mr. Murphy requested that the School Committee develop a policy on no trespass orders.

Ms. Dunn and Mr. Zimmerman recommended that we standardize the process for developing and reviewing proposed PSB policies to ensure adequate legal review and timely opportunities for staff and parent/guardian input. The administration will work with principals and school site councils and PTOs to facilitate opportunities for input. Ms. Schreiner-Oldham requested that staff flag proposed policy language that is required by federal/state law and/or regulation.

3) Review of Proposed PSB Wellness Policy

The Subcommittee reviewed the proposed PSB Wellness Policy (Attachment A). The proposed draft reflects modifications suggested at the last meeting, formatting changes for ease of review, and feedback offered at the last meeting of the Wellness Committee. Substantive language revisions since the last Policy Review Subcommittee meeting include the following:

Page 1: section Food Available in School now incorporates the food allergy management plan and policy language.

Page 2: section School Meal Content Guidelines now has the specific language of Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) part 210 and 220.

Page 3: section b. regarding food fundraisers now incorporates United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) language exemption as provided in CFR part 210 and 220.

The Wellness Committee reviewed the proposed draft and agreed that it maintains our core values. Mr. Zimmerman incorporated comments related to recess and the food allergy policy. He has asked Town Counsel to opine on two legal issues. Mr. Zimmerman also incorporated parent suggestions, e.g., listing the eight most common food allergens.

Mr. Zimmerman noted that there is “a special exemption for the sale of food and/or beverages that do not meet the competitive food standards as required in this section for the purpose of conducting an infrequent school-sponsored fundraiser.” He commented that language requiring 20 minutes of recess after lunch may require some changes to building scheduling. The administration will work with principals on this issue. Ms. Perry noted that the 20 minutes for recess includes transition times. Ms. Dunn stated that we can talk to principals about how we might improve our practices around transitions.

Subcommittee members suggested making school fundraisers a separate section (including language from the last section on page 2; section b1 on page 3, move down so it becomes section c).

Staff will revise the draft, solicit feedback from school leaders and groups, and then present the revised policy to the School Committee for a 1st Reading in September.

The meeting adjourned at 10:00 AM.

Updated Draft - June 9th, 2017

Wellness Policy

The Public Schools of Brookline (PSB) is committed to providing school environments that promote and protect children's health, well-being, and ability to learn by supporting wellness, good nutrition and regular physical activity as part of the total learning environment. The PSB supports a healthy environment where children learn about and participate in positive dietary and lifestyle practices. In an effort to support these goals, the following values guide this policy and its corresponding implementation and procedures:

Cultivate a school culture that values wellness – physical and mental health of all its students and their communities – by offering thoughtful, inclusive, and appropriate support and instruction throughout all schools.

Provide comprehensive health education including but not limited to mental and physical health, nutrition and food literacy, physical activity, allergy and public health concerns, alcohol and other substance abuse, peer pressure, body image, and eating disorders. At its very core, comprehensive school health education is about keeping students healthy now and in the future, reinforcing positive healthy behaviors throughout the school day, and making it clear that good health and learning go hand in hand.

Destigmatize differences due to mental and physical health or disability, culture, race, religion, language, national origin, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, or socio-economic status through consciousness raising and providing space for public learning, conversation, and discussion.

I. Food Available in School

The PSB addresses guidelines for students who have life threatening food allergies within the management guidelines for students who have life-threatening allergies.

The PSB supports school food environments in which every food option is a good choice - choices which support good health, academic achievement, physical activity, and individual choice. It is a priority to adjust for differentials in resources, food knowledge and exposure, and food practices, cultures, and needs. Accordingly, the PSB aim to serve foods that will promote good health, pleasure in eating, and reinforce important health education objectives.

Student Access and Participation in Meal Programs

1. The PSB aims to provide a stigma-free meal environment where all students are provided fresh, nutritious foods that support physical growth and learning. Specifically, free and reduced priced meals will be served and sold in a manner indistinguishable by students or staff from the regularly priced meals.
2. PSB strives to meet or exceed best administrative practices for enrollment, participation, and payment of food, including:
 - a. Ensuring that the direct certification process is being complied with for automatically eligible students;
 - b. On a regular basis checking and coordinating with county social services and similar public benefit administering agencies to ensure that every eligible child is enrolled in free/reduced price meal programs;

- c. Developing a coordinated, comprehensive outreach and promotion plan directed at both students and families, including a language access component to ensure language-appropriate documents and highlighting access options for students with disabilities.
- d. Implementing and maintaining a card-swipe or similar payment system in place that eliminates the stigma of accepting “free/reduced” lunch.
- e. Ensure at least 20 minutes of time to eat *after food is served*. This will allow enough time for students to get their lunch and need it. Students need to socialize while eating, and if forced to choose due to shortness of time will usually respond to social prompts to talk rather than eat. Accommodate special dietary needs and offer foods that permit individual choice and
- f. strive to reflect the ethnic and cultural preferences of the community.

Encourage participation in the meal programs by adults in the school community, whether staff or parent. This is highly effective modeling.

School Meal Content Guidelines

- a. Meet and when possible exceed the Nutrition Standards in the National School Lunch and Breakfast Programs <https://www.gpo.gov/fdsys/pkg/FR-2012-01-26/pdf/2012-1010.pdf> and the Massachusetts and USDA Competitive Foods and Beverage Nutrition Standards <http://www.mass.gov/eohhs/gov/departments/dph/programs/community-health/mass-in-motion/school/nutrition-regs/> taking advantage of exemptions for unprocessed fruits and vegetables. To the extent that current nutrition science indicates a higher standard is the better practice, the higher standard should be applied. Source local, regional, organic when budgetary permissible and available.
 - i. Under the Nutrition Standards in the National School Lunch and Breakfast program (7 CFR Parts 210 and 220) guidelines;
 - 1. This rule requires most schools to increase the availability of fruits, vegetables, whole grains, and fat free and low-fat fluid milk in school meals; reduce the levels of sodium, saturated fat and trans fat in meals; and meet the nutrition needs of school children within their calorie requirements. These improvements to the school meal programs, largely based on recommendations made by the Institute of Medicine of the National Academies, are expected to enhance the diet and health of school children, and help mitigate the childhood obesity trend.
- b. Serve real, minimally processed food without additives when budgetarily possible and available. Fresh and freshly prepared food options should be available to every student at every meal.
- c. Except for fresh fruits and vegetables and other whole foods, make ingredient and nutrition and allergy information readily available to students before purchasing meals, and to families in advance of the school day, for foods and beverages served in schools.

Snacks offered or sold to students outside or as part of the food service program or vending machines will comply with Smart Snacks or Massachusetts DESE snack standards per regulations 7 CFR 210.11 105 CMR 225.000 as not compete with meals offered by the school food service program.

Fundraisers that involve food sales will comply with 7 CFR 210.11(a) and occur 30 minutes after the school day ends. Must also meet the [Massachusetts and USDA Competitive Foods and Beverage Nutrition Standards](#) and guidance provided by [MA Dept of Health and Human Services](#) for school nutrition.

Food at School Events, Field Trips, Celebrations, and Fundraisers

- a. Given the implicit school endorsement, foods offered at any school events (including testing days, assemblies, etc.) will be wholesome, nutritious, clearly marked for the eight (8) common allergens (peanut, tree nut, milk, soy, egg, wheat, fish, and shellfish), and meet or exceed the district's nutrition standards for food in school set forth above.
- b. Food fundraisers or food sold on behalf of the schools will also feature whole or minimally processed high nutrient foods, such as fruits, and vegetables, and be consistent with the standards and objectives of the wellness policy while being in accordance with National School Lunch Program and School Breakfast Program: Nutrition Standards for All Foods Sold in School as Required by the Healthy, Hunger Free Kids Act of 2010 (7 CFR Parts 210 and 220) which provides the following exemption:
 - 1. (4) Fundraiser restrictions. Competitive food and beverage items sold during the school day must meet the nutrition standards for competitive food as required in this section. A special exemption is allowed for the sale of food and/or beverages that do not meet the competitive food standards as required in this section for the purpose of conducting an infrequent school-sponsored fundraiser. Such specially exempted fundraisers must not take place more than the frequency specified by the State agency during such periods that schools are in session. No specially exempted fundraiser foods or beverages may be sold in competition with school meals in the food service area during the meal service.
- c. Lunch time meetings will not be used as a consequence. Tutoring, clubs, and meetings may take place during lunch time if students are provided with the opportunity to get lunch.

Competitive Foods and Beverages & Food Marketing

- a. Foods should compare favorably with meal program offerings, and meet or exceed the same standards set forth above.
- b. These standards apply in all locations where food and beverages are offered or sold in schools: cafeterias, restaurants, student run culinary program, cafes, vending machines, stores, and snack or other food carts.
- c. Only foods that meet or exceed district standards may be marketed or promoted to students.
- d. PSB will prioritize marketing whole or minimally processed foods to students.
- e. Fruit and non-fried vegetables will be offered for sale wherever food is sold.
- f. Only Office of Administration and Finance approved brand names , trademarks, or logos from companies that offer only product lines (both in and outside of schools) consistent with the Wellness Policy nutrition guidelines will appear in schools, during school activities, or in school materials, including, but not limited to curriculum or educational materials, food and beverage containers, menus, school publications, posters, electronic media, or vending machines.

Ensure the safety and inclusion of students with food allergies and other special health concerns.

II. Nutrition Education

The PSB will aim to provide nutrition, health and food literacy education to students at every grade level as part of a sequential, comprehensive, standards-based health education curriculum and/or as embedding in multi-disciplinary units that meets state and national standards. Curriculum will be selected, developed and coordinated so that both dedicated health and nutrition units as well as other classroom and non-classroom settings are used in concert to further this goal. Appropriately, the

district will take steps to ensure trained and dually licensed physical and health educators will be identified and tasked with this coordination with appropriate content area partners. The K-12 coordinator of Physical Education and Health will partner with appropriate content coordinators to prepare materials, conduct or arrange for outreach and trainings, and providing technical support and resources to teachers.

In furtherance of the core values set forth above, in the context of food and nutrition in its schools, the PSB will:

1. **Providing a food-positive school food environment**, in which real food is freshly prepared from whole or minimally processed ingredients to maximize naturally occurring nutrients and good taste while minimizing unnecessary additives and waste, whether in a meal program or any other school setting.
2. **Teaching students to be critical, astute consumers** who know how to navigate both their food environment and their health support system, seek out current science, and modify their behavior to cultivate good health.
3. **Teaching food literacy** in the classroom, in experiential learning settings like school gardens and teaching kitchens, in the cafeteria, and in other food settings; practice what is preached in nutrition education; and ensure that adults model good choices throughout schools.
4. **Provide a range of wholesome, nutritious, and delicious breakfast, lunch, snack and special event foods to all students.** Holding its food service program to the Nutrition Standards in the National School Lunch and Breakfast Programs <https://www.gpo.gov/fdsys/pkg/FR-2012-01-26/pdf/2012-1010.pdf> and the Massachusetts and USDA Competitive Foods and Beverage Nutrition Standards <http://www.mass.gov/eohhs/gov/departments/dph/programs/community-health/mass-in-motion/school/nutrition> regs/ the PSB will ensure that its foods are equally accessible to all students irrespective of ability to pay; consistent with the health, ethnic, and cultural needs of the internal school community; and contribute to the health of the greater community by supporting a healthy, sustainable, and fair local and regional food system.

III. Health Education, Physical Education and Physical Activity

The Public Schools of Brookline will provide a range of physical activity opportunities to all students, including regular physical education, daily recess and physical activity breaks, before and after school activities, active academics as well as comprehensive health education.

Teachers and other school and community personnel will not use physical activity (*e.g.*, running laps, push-ups) or withhold opportunities for physical education or physical activity (*e.g.*, recess,) as punishment in adherence with the Public Schools of Brookline Disciplinary policy.

1. Physical Education

- a. All PSB students grades K-12, including students with disabilities, special health-care needs, and in alternative educational settings will receive physical education each year.
- b. All physical education will be taught by a licensed physical education teacher. Age, ability, and developmentally appropriate modifications will be made to accommodate the needs of all students. Students will spend at least 70 percent of physical education class time participating in moderate to vigorous physical activity.
- c. Teachers will provide a comfortable and safe learning environment. Physical education equipment will be age and developmentally appropriate.

2. Daily Recess

- a. All PSB K-8 students will be provided with the opportunity for at least 20 minutes a day of supervised recess, preferably outdoors weather permitting dependent at the discretion of the school principal.
- b. Current research indicates the need for students to move throughout the school day. As a result of district work with Dr. John Ratey, author of Spark, The Revolutionary New Science of Exercise and the Brain, the PSB will continue to train all teachers to understand that short exercise bursts create increased brain activity, resulting in students who are more focused and ready to learn. Classroom teachers are provided with resources for increasing student heart rates periodically throughout the school day.
- c. All PSB will offer extracurricular physical activity programs, such as physical activity clubs or intramural programs. The high school and middle school grades will have after school sports programs. Schools will offer a range of activities that meet the needs, interests, and abilities of all students, including all genders, students with disabilities, and students with special health-care needs. Students will have access to resources for community activities.

3. Health Education

- a. PSB are committed to providing a school environment that promotes students' physical, emotional, intellectual, and social well-being.
- b. The health education program will utilize a skills-based approach designed to provide students with opportunities to develop and maintain the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and behaviors necessary to be healthy and physically active for a lifetime. The health education curricula will be aligned with the state and National Health Education Standards. The PSB Health education shall be taught by certified health education teachers. We aim to start a specific health education curriculum in grade 6. Currently such curriculum is taught in grades 7-9 as described in our Program Review Report, hereby incorporated into this policy by reference.

IV. Social and Emotional Health and Wellbeing

The Public Schools of Brookline is committed to promoting the social and emotional wellbeing of its student body. Brookline's commitment to addressing student mental health has six objectives:

1. Foster a school **culture of overall acceptance and respect** for differences. De-stigmatize mental health issues, whether referring to individuals with clinical diagnoses (such as anxiety or bipolar disorder) or those struggling with personal or family stresses or other social/emotional issues. Educate students and staff about some of the the unique issues and barriers LBGTQ students, student of color, and students from diverse backgrounds may face. Create an environment in which it is safe and acceptable to talk about differences and ask for help.
2. **Provide age-appropriate social and emotional literacy and education.** Teach effective strategies and practices to support mental health, resilience and well-being throughout all grades, including skills that promote healthy behaviors in relation to nutrition, exercise, interpersonal relationships, stress management, mindfulness, injury prevention and substance abuse.
3. **Raise awareness in the community** (students, parents, schools staff, coaches) about the signs and symptoms of mental health, social/emotional issues, and substance abuse, keeping in mind that many behavioral and academic struggles, are often manifestations of compromised mental health or personal or family and stresses. Provide training on how to reach out to students and

help them access support and treatment services. Ensure that all school staff are trained on emergency procedures, including when to report concerns to administration and support staff.

4. **Ensure that in-school support services** (guidance, social workers, adjustment counselors, psychologists, nursing staff) are accessible to all students presenting with social, emotional, mental health and substance abuse issues for screening, referral and ongoing counseling in school counseling as needed. Trained licensed clinical staff will be available to respond to social service and psychiatric emergencies during school hours.
5. **Provide specialized instruction programs** as identified by individualized education plans for students with diagnosed mental health disorders that impede their ability to effective progress in regular classrooms. Support students struggling with social and emotional issues to achieve academically to the best of their abilities.
6. **Promote wellbeing and balance** by addressing the policies and practices around the intersection of academic expectations/achievement and student mental health.